IGCSE GEOGRAPHY 0460 | THEME 1.3 | REVISION PACK

Population Structure

CASE STUDY | Nigeria — Youthful Population

CASE STUDY | Japan — Ageing Population

SYLLABUS OBJECTIVES | What you need to know

- Define and distinguish between youthful and ageing population structures
- Describe and interpret population pyramids — shape, features and DTM link
- Calculate and interpret the dependency ratio using the formula
- Describe the causes of Nigeria's youthful population structure with data
- Explain the problems and opportunities of Nigeria's youthful structure
- Describe the causes of Japan's ageing population structure with data
- Explain the problems and management responses to Japan's ageing population
- Compare youthful and ageing populations — for 4 and 7 mark questions

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1. Key Concepts and Definitions

Population structure describes the composition of a population by **age** and **sex**. It is shown visually using a **population pyramid** and is closely linked to a country's stage in the Demographic Transition Model (DTM). Two contrasting structures dominate the Cambridge syllabus: **youthful populations** (Stage 2–3) and **ageing populations** (Stage 4–5).

Population structure	The composition of a population by age group and sex.
Population pyramid	A bar chart showing the age and sex structure of a population. Age increases up the y-axis; males on left, females on right.
Youthful population	A population with a HIGH proportion of young people (under 15). Wide base on pyramid. Typical of DTM Stage 2–3.
Ageing population	A population with a HIGH proportion of elderly people (65+). Wide top and narrow base on pyramid. Typical of DTM Stage 4–5.
Dependency ratio	The ratio of dependants (under 15 + over 65) to working-age people (15–64), × 100. High ratio = more economic pressure on workers.
Youth dependency ratio	Dependants aged 0–14 as a proportion of the working-age population. High in youthful populations (e.g. Nigeria).
Elderly dependency ratio	Dependants aged 65+ as a proportion of the working-age population. High in ageing populations (e.g. Japan).
Life expectancy	The average number of years a person is expected to live from birth. Japan: ~84 yrs; Nigeria: ~54 yrs.
Population momentum	Continued population growth even after TFR falls, because large numbers of young people are still reproducing.
Median age	The age that divides a population in half — 50% above, 50% below. Japan: 49 years (one of world's highest). Nigeria: 18 years.
Sex ratio	The number of males per 100 females. Can be distorted by war (male deaths), selective abortion, or gender-specific emigration.
Age-sex structure	Another term for population structure — the breakdown by both age group and gender simultaneously.

2. Reading and Interpreting Population Pyramids

A population pyramid is the key diagram for this topic. Each horizontal bar represents one 5-year age group. The **width** of each bar shows the proportion (%) of the total population in that group. **Males** are always on the **left**; **females** on the **right**.

Shape / Type	What it looks like	What it means	DTM Stage	Example
Expansive (Pyramid shape)	Very wide base, rapidly narrows toward top	High BR and DR; low life expectancy; rapid population growth; very high youth dependency	Stage 2	Niger, Yemen
Transitional (Bell shape)	Wide base, tapering more gradually	Falling BR; falling DR; growth slowing; more balanced age structure beginning to emerge	Stage 3	Nigeria, India

Shape / Type	What it looks like	What it means	DTM Stage	Example
Stationary (Rectangle)	Nearly equal bar widths throughout; slight taper at top	Low BR and DR; stable population; balanced age structure; low dependency ratio	Stage 4	USA, Australia, France
Constrictive (Coffin / Urn)	Narrower at base than middle/top; wide elderly cohorts	Very low BR; ageing population; shrinking workforce; very high elderly dependency ratio	Stage 4–5	Japan, Germany, Italy

EXAM TIP

Always comment on THREE features of a pyramid: (1) the BASE (birth rate / young people), (2) the SIDES (rate of change / death rate), (3) the TOP (life expectancy / elderly). Then link each observation to a cause.
Example: "The very wide base (8% in 0–4 age group) indicates a high birth rate — typical of Stage 2 countries where children are valued as economic assets and contraception access is limited."

3. The Dependency Ratio

The dependency ratio measures the economic burden on the working-age population. A **high ratio** means each worker must support more dependants — placing greater strain on government finances, healthcare and pension systems.

DEPENDENCY RATIO FORMULA

Dependency ratio = (population 0–14 + population 65+) ÷ population 15–64 × 100

A ratio of **50** means there are 50 dependants per 100 working-age people. A ratio above 50 indicates majority-dependant population.

Country	Under 15 (%)	15–64 (%)	65+ (%)	Dep. Ratio	Type of problem
Nigeria (2023)	43%	54%	3%	85	HIGH YOUTH dependency — schools, healthcare for children
Japan (2023)	12%	59%	29%	70	HIGH ELDERLY dependency — pensions, nursing, healthcare
UK (2023)	17%	63%	20%	59	Mixed — growing elderly dependency pressure
Germany (2023)	14%	63%	23%	59	Rising elderly dependency — similar to Japan trajectory

EXAM ALERT

Nigeria and Japan BOTH have high dependency ratios — but for COMPLETELY DIFFERENT reasons. Nigeria's is high because of a large **young** population (youth dependency). Japan's is high because of a large **elderly** population (elderly dependency). The problems they create are also very different — always specify which type.

4. Youthful Population — Case Study: Nigeria

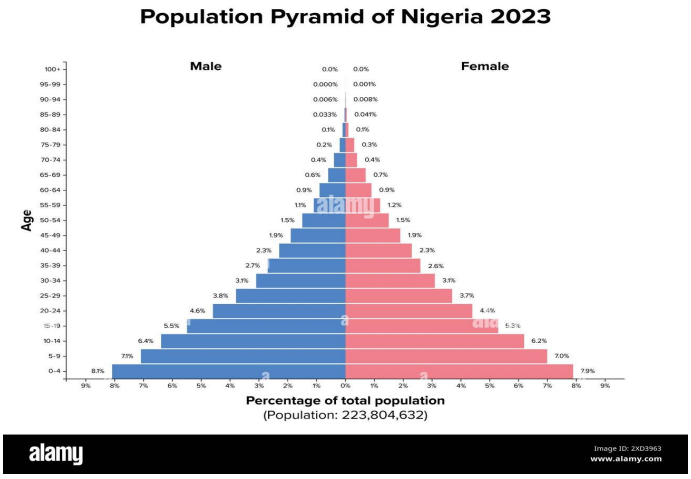

Fig 4.1 — Left: Overcrowded Nigerian classroom — a direct consequence of a youthful population and high birth rate. Right: Population Pyramid of Nigeria 2023 (population 223.8 million). The very wide base and rapidly narrowing top confirm an expansive Stage 3 structure.

FAST FACTS — NIGERIA

Population: 223.8 million (2023) | Median age: 18 years | Growth rate: ~2.4%/year
Under 15: 43% of population | Over 65: only 3% | Youth dependency ratio: ~80
Birth rate: ~35/1,000 | Death rate: ~11/1,000 | TFR: ~5.1 children per woman
DTM Stage: 3 (late expanding) | Life expectancy: ~54 years

Causes of Nigeria's Youthful Population Structure

Cause	Detail and Data
High birth rate (TFR 5.1)	Children are valued as economic assets and old-age security in a subsistence-farming society with no state pension. Cultural and religious norms celebrate large families. TFR of 5.1 means women have on average 5 children each.
Early marriage	Over 40% of Nigerian girls marry before age 18, extending the reproductive period and increasing total children per woman. Particularly common in northern Nigeria where literacy rates are lowest.
Limited contraception	Only ~17% of Nigerian women use modern contraception — far below the global average of ~55%. Poor rural infrastructure, cultural resistance and cost all limit access.
Falling death rate	Improved healthcare and vaccination has cut infant mortality from ~130 (2000) to ~72/1,000 (2023), but birth rate remains very high. More children survive — increasing the young age groups dramatically.
Population momentum	With 43% of the population under 15, enormous numbers are entering reproductive age — ensuring continued rapid growth even if TFR starts to fall. Nigeria's population will reach 400 million+ by 2050.
Low female education	Nigeria's female secondary school completion rate is under 40%. Research consistently shows educated women have fewer children — low education maintains high fertility.

Problems of Nigeria's Youthful Population Structure

Problem	Detail and Impact
Overwhelmed schools	Nigeria needs 400,000+ new classrooms per year to keep pace with demand. Primary school class sizes of 60–80+ pupils are common. 20 million children are out of school — the world's highest number. Teacher shortage severe.

Problem	Detail and Impact
Healthcare pressure	Only 1 doctor per 5,000 people nationally (vs. 1 per 300 in Japan). Maternal mortality rate is 1,047 per 100,000 births — one of the world's highest. Hospitals chronically underfunded.
Youth unemployment	Labour supply massively outstrips demand — youth unemployment exceeds 40%. Most young workers are in the low-paid informal sector. This creates social instability and drives rural-urban migration to cities like Lagos.
Housing shortage	Rapid urban growth — Lagos grows by 600,000 people per year. Over 60% of Lagos residents live in informal settlements (slums) like Makoko with no clean water, sanitation or security of tenure.
High government spending	Government must fund schools, clinics and infrastructure for a huge young population while tax revenues from a smaller working-age population are limited. Very high youth dependency ratio (~80) strains public finances severely.
Food insecurity	Nigeria cannot produce enough food for its rapidly growing population despite fertile farmland. It imports food to fill the gap — spending foreign exchange on imports rather than development.

Opportunities of Nigeria's Youthful Population Structure

Opportunity	Detail
Demographic dividend	IF fertility falls and the large young cohort enters the workforce, Nigeria could experience rapid economic growth — as happened in South Korea, China and India. This requires investment in education and job creation NOW.
Large future workforce	Nigeria will have the world's 3rd largest workforce by 2050. A young, working-age population can drive economic growth, pay taxes and support ageing populations elsewhere — if skills are developed.
Growing consumer market	A large young population creates a huge domestic market for goods and services. Nigeria is already the largest economy in Africa. Businesses see enormous potential in its young consumers.
Military and civic strength	A high proportion of military-age adults strengthens defence capacity. A young population can volunteer for civic programmes and drive social change.

5. Ageing Population — Case Study: Japan

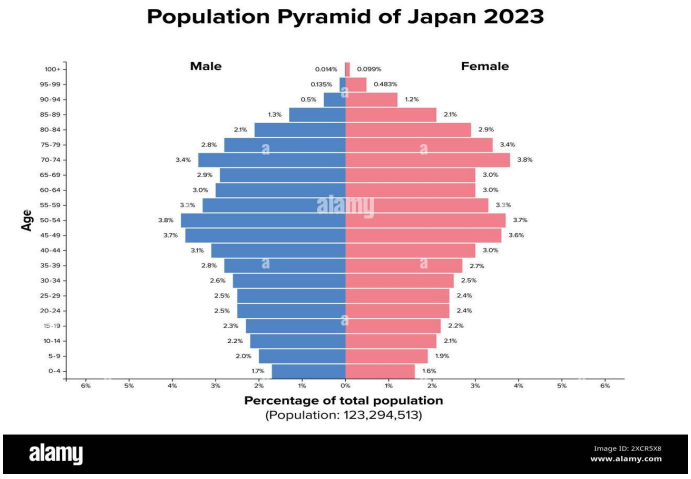

Fig 5.1 — Left: Elderly Japanese residents in wheelchairs outside a care home. Japan has the world's highest proportion of elderly citizens (29% over 65). Right: Population Pyramid of Japan 2023 (population 123.3 million). The characteristic "coffin" shape — narrow base, wide 45–75 bulge — confirms a Stage 4–5 declining population.

FAST FACTS — JAPAN

Population: 123.3 million (2023) — falling; peaked at 128 million in 2010
Median age: 49 years — one of the highest in the world
Over 65: 29% of population | Under 15: only 12% | Elderly dependency ratio: ~49
Birth rate: ~7/1,000 | Death rate: ~13/1,000 | Natural decrease every year since 2007
TFR: 1.2 (2023 record low) | DTM Stage: 5 | Life expectancy: ~84 years (women: 87, men: 81)

Causes of Japan's Ageing Population Structure

Cause	Detail and Data
Extremely low TFR (1.2)	Japan's TFR of 1.2 is well below the replacement level of 2.1. High cost of living, expensive childcare, long working hours and small urban apartments deter couples from having children. Many young Japanese reject marriage entirely.
World's highest life expectancy	Japanese women live on average 87 years; men 81 years. Excellent healthcare, low obesity rates, healthy diet (fish, vegetables) and strong social bonds all contribute. More people survive into very old age.
Very low immigration	Japan has historically accepted very few immigrants — net migration adds only ~100,000 per year to a population of 123 million. Unlike Germany or the UK, Japan cannot offset low birth rate with immigration. Small policy changes since 2019.
Baby boom legacy	A large cohort born 1947–1949 (post-WW2 baby boom) is now aged 74–76. This "dankai" generation is entering old age simultaneously, creating a sudden spike in elderly dependants requiring healthcare and pensions.
Cultural and economic barriers	Japanese workplace culture expects extreme long hours from workers. Women face effective choice between career and family — many choose career. Average age at first marriage (30+ for men) reduces time for childrearing.

Problems of Japan's Ageing Population Structure

Problem	Detail and Impact
Pension crisis	Japan spends ~10% of GDP on pensions. With 29% of the population over 65 and only 59% of working age, the ratio of workers to pensioners is shrinking. In 1950 there were 10 workers per retiree; today fewer than 2. The system is under severe financial stress.

Problem	Detail and Impact
Healthcare costs	Elderly people use healthcare services far more intensively than young people. Japan's healthcare spending has doubled as a share of GDP since 1990. Nursing care for the very old (Japan has 80,000+ people over 100) is extremely expensive.
Shrinking workforce	Japan's working-age population is falling by ~600,000 per year. Labour shortages are severe in construction, agriculture, nursing and transport. GDP growth is constrained by insufficient workers.
Rural depopulation	Young people move to cities, leaving elderly populations in rural villages. Many remote Japanese villages have no residents under 60. Schools, hospitals and shops close as populations fall below viable thresholds.
Declining tax base	Fewer working-age people pay less income tax and social security contributions. At the same time government spending on pensions and healthcare rises. Japan already has the world's highest public debt (~260% of GDP).
Mental health and loneliness	Japan has a growing "lonely death" (kodokushi) phenomenon — elderly people dying alone undiscovered for weeks. Social isolation among the elderly is a serious public health issue.

Japan's Management Strategies for an Ageing Population

Strategy	What it involves	Evaluation
Raising retirement age	Retirement age raised to 65; government encouraging voluntary work to 70+. Many firms now employ workers in their 70s.	Keeps more people in the workforce longer — reduces pension burden. But physically demanding work is difficult at 70+.
Robot automation	Japan leads the world in industrial and care robots. Robots used in factories, nursing homes, restaurants and retail to offset labour shortage.	Effective in manufacturing. Care robots can assist but cannot replace human companionship or complex care. Very expensive to implement.
Pro-natalist policies (Angel Plans)	Monthly child benefits (up to 15,000 yen/child/month); free pre-school from age 3 (2019); extended parental leave; 2023 emergency package tripling child benefits.	TFR STILL falling at record low 1.2 despite decades of policies. Root causes (cost, work culture, housing) remain unaddressed. Policies largely ineffective.
Immigration reforms	From 2019, Japan expanded skilled worker visas allowing longer stays. Net migration has increased slightly to ~200,000/year.	Still very limited compared to UK, Germany. Cultural barriers to integration remain significant. A larger policy change would be needed to make real demographic difference.
Pension reform	Raised contribution rates; linking pension increases to demographic factors; encouraging private pension saving.	Partially stabilises the pension system. But with shrinking worker base, long-term sustainability remains in question.

6. Comparison: Youthful vs Ageing Populations

Feature	Nigeria (Youthful — Stage 3)	Japan (Ageing — Stage 4–5)
Median age	18 years	49 years
TFR	5.1 (well above replacement)	1.2 (well below replacement)
Under 15 (%)	43%	12%
Over 65 (%)	3%	29%
Dependency ratio	~85 (youth-dominated)	~70 (elderly-dominated)
Main dependency type	Youth: schools, healthcare for children	Elderly: pensions, nursing, care

Feature	Nigeria (Youthful — Stage 3)	Japan (Ageing — Stage 4–5)
Pyramid shape	Expansive — wide base, tapering top	Constrictive — narrow base, wide top
DTM stage	Stage 3 (late expanding)	Stage 4–5 (low stationary / declining)
Key problem	Overwhelmed services; youth unemployment	Pension / healthcare cost; shrinking workforce
Key opportunity / challenge	Potential demographic dividend if educated	Robot automation; immigration reform
Life expectancy	~54 years	~84 years
Population trend	Growing rapidly (+2.4%/year)	Declining (natural decrease since 2007)

7. Key Vocabulary — 15 Terms You Must Know

Population structure	Composition of a population by age and sex, shown on a population pyramid.
Population pyramid	Bar chart showing age-sex structure. Males left; females right; age increases upward.
Youthful population	High proportion under 15. Wide pyramid base. High birth rate. Stage 2–3.
Ageing population	High proportion over 65. Narrow pyramid base, wide top. Low birth rate. Stage 4–5.
Dependency ratio	(Pop 0–14 + pop 65+) ÷ pop 15–64 × 100. Shows burden on working-age population.
Youth dependency	Dependants aged 0–14 as proportion of working-age. High in Nigeria (~80).
Elderly dependency	Dependants aged 65+ as proportion of working-age. High in Japan (~49).
Median age	Age that divides population in half. Nigeria: 18 yrs (very young). Japan: 49 yrs (very old).
Life expectancy	Average years expected to live from birth. Japan 84; Nigeria 54.
TFR	Total Fertility Rate — average children per woman. Replacement = 2.1. Nigeria 5.1; Japan 1.2.
Demographic dividend	Economic boom when large youthful cohort moves into workforce — potential for Nigeria.
Population momentum	Continued growth even as TFR falls, due to large young cohort still reproducing.
Sex ratio	Males per 100 females. Distorted by war, selective abortion, or gender-specific emigration.
Kodokushi	Japanese "lonely death" — dying alone undiscovered. Consequence of elderly isolation.
Dankai generation	Japan's post-WW2 baby boom cohort (born 1947–49), now entering old age together.

8. Syllabus Checklist — Cambridge 0460 Theme 1.3

- Define population structure and explain how it is shown using a population pyramid
- Describe and identify the four main pyramid shapes and link each to a DTM stage
- Calculate the dependency ratio using the formula — and identify youth vs elderly types
- Explain why Nigeria has a youthful population structure — with specific data

- Describe the problems caused by Nigeria's youthful structure with named evidence
- Explain the potential opportunities of Nigeria's youthful population (demographic dividend)
- Explain why Japan has an ageing population structure — TFR, life expectancy, immigration
- Describe the problems caused by Japan's ageing structure — pensions, healthcare, workforce
- Describe and evaluate at least THREE strategies Japan uses to manage its ageing population
- Compare youthful and ageing populations using specific data from both case studies
- Use specific statistics in every answer — TFR, dependency ratio, % elderly, life expectancy
- Write a 7-mark extended response using PEEL with named data and an evaluative conclusion

9. Exam Alert — Common Mistakes and Mark-Winning Tips

COMMON MISTAKES TO AVOID

✗ Do NOT say Nigeria and Japan both have "high dependency ratios" without specifying WHY they differ — Nigeria's is youth-dominated; Japan's is elderly-dominated. The distinction is worth marks.

✗ Do NOT describe a pyramid without explaining what the shape means — "the wide base shows a high birth rate because children are valued as economic assets in Nigeria's subsistence-farming society."

✗ Do NOT confuse TFR with birth rate — TFR is children per woman (Nigeria 5.1; Japan 1.2). Birth rate is per 1,000 people per year (Nigeria ~35; Japan ~7).

✗ Do NOT say Japan's pro-natalist policies have "worked" — TFR is STILL FALLING at 1.2 despite decades of Angel Plans. Japan's policies have largely FAILED.

✗ Do NOT forget to include the opportunity side for Nigeria — the demographic dividend is a potential positive outcome of a youthful structure if conditions are right.

✗ Do NOT mix up DTM stage with dependency ratio — they are different concepts that happen to correlate.

MARK-WINNING TIPS

✓ Always name your case study: "In Nigeria..." / "Japan's ageing population..." — never "a country with a youthful structure."

✓ For pyramid descriptions, comment on: (1) base width → birth rate, (2) sides → death rate/natural increase, (3) top → life expectancy.

✓ For comparison questions: use a clear structure — cause → consequence → named data. Then contrast: "In contrast, Japan..."

✓ For 7-mark questions: PEEL — Point (name case study + state structure), Evidence (TFR, %, median age), Explain (WHY it is youthful/ageing), Link (evaluate or compare).

✓ Key data targets: Nigeria (TFR 5.1; median age 18; 43% under 15; dependency ratio ~85) and Japan (TFR 1.2; median age 49; 29% over 65; dependency ratio ~70).

10. Exam Practice Questions — Cambridge 0460 Style

All questions follow Cambridge 0460 Paper 1 style. Section B uses the 1 + 2 + 3 + 4 + 7 mark structure.

Question 1 [1 mark]

(a) What is the term for the ratio of dependants (under 15 and over 65) to the working-age population? [1]

✓ **MARK SCHEME**

1 mark: Dependency ratio (accept: age dependency ratio)

Question 2 [2 marks]

(b) State two features of a population pyramid that would indicate a youthful population. [2]

✓ **MARK SCHEME**

1 mark each for any two correct distinct features (max 2):

Wide base / large bars in 0-4 and 5-9 age groups | Pyramid shape narrows sharply toward top

Large proportion under 15 | Very narrow top bars showing few elderly

Note: must describe a pyramid FEATURE, not just state high birth rate.

Question 3 [3 marks]

(c) Explain why Japan has an ageing population structure. [3]

✓ **MARK SCHEME**

1 mark per developed point (max 3):

Very low TFR (1.2) well below replacement (2.1) -- fewer young people entering population + explanation

Very high life expectancy (~84 years) -- more people surviving into old age + explanation

Very low immigration -- cannot offset natural decrease + explanation

Baby boom cohort (dankai) now all reaching old age simultaneously + explanation

Max 3 marks. Must include explanation, not just a list of causes.

Question 4 [4 marks]

(d) For a named country with a youthful population structure, describe and explain the problems this creates. Named country: _____ [4]

✓ **MARK SCHEME**

Credit well-developed problems with explanation and named data (max 4 marks):

Nigeria: overwhelmed schools -- 20 million children out of school; class sizes 60-80+ + explanation

Healthcare pressure -- 1 doctor per 5,000 people; maternal mortality 1,047/100,000 + explanation

Youth unemployment -- exceeds 40%; informal sector dominates + explanation

Housing shortage -- 60%+ of Lagos in informal settlements + explanation

Must name a country. Max 2 marks without named data or explanation.

Question 5a — Extended Writing [7 marks]

(e) For a named country you have studied, describe and explain the problems caused by its population structure. [7]

Named country: _____

✓ MARK SCHEME — LEVEL DESCRIPTORS

Level 3 [6–7]: Named case study throughout; THREE or more specific problems described AND explained with data; problems linked to population structure; evaluative/comparative conclusion. Specific data essential (TFR, %, dependency ratio).

Level 2 [4–5]: Named case study; some data; problems described with limited explanation. Mainly one type of problem.

Level 1 [1–3]: Basic description only; vague; little or no data.

Japan example: Pension crisis (10% GDP; workers:retirees fell from 10:1 to under 2:1) + shrinking workforce (-600k/yr; labour shortages in healthcare, farming) + rural depopulation (villages with no residents under 60) + declining tax base (public debt 260% GDP).

Nigeria example: Overwhelmed schools (20m out of school; class sizes 60-80+) + youth unemployment (40%; informal sector) + housing shortage (60%+ Lagos in slums) + healthcare pressure (1 doctor per 5,000 people).

PEEL FRAMEWORK	Japan example (ageing) / Nigeria example (youthful)
P — POINT Name the country and state its population structure.	"Japan has an ageing population structure, with 29% of its population aged 65+ and a TFR of just 1.2." OR "Nigeria has a youthful population structure, with 43% under 15 and a TFR of 5.1."
E — EVIDENCE Back up with specific data.	Japan elderly dependency ratio is approximately 49 -- meaning 49 elderly dependants per 100 workers. Healthcare spending has doubled as a share of GDP since 1990.
E — EXPLAIN Explain WHY this is a problem.	"This is a problem because fewer workers must support more pensioners — the ratio has fallen from 10:1 in 1950 to under 2:1 today, placing pensions under severe financial strain."
L — LINK Link back to the question. Develop or add a second problem.	A further problem is... [add second problem with data]. Overall, Japan ageing structure creates severe economic strain across multiple sectors simultaneously."

Question 5b — Extended Writing (Alternative) [7 marks]

(e) For a named country you have studied with an ageing population, describe and evaluate the strategies used to manage the problems caused by its population structure. [7]

Named country: _____

✓ MARK SCHEME — LEVEL DESCRIPTORS

Level 3 [6–7]: Named country; THREE or more strategies described in detail; each evaluated (success AND limitation); evidence used; balanced conclusion reached.

Level 2 [4–5]: Two strategies described; some evaluation; limited data.

Level 1 [1–3]: Strategies listed but not described or evaluated.

Japan strategies to evaluate: Angel Plans — FAILING (TFR still 1.2 despite decades); Robot automation — effective in industry, limited in care; Raised retirement age — keeps workers longer but physically demanding; Immigration reform — small increase but culturally limited; Pension reform — partially stabilises system but long-term sustainability in doubt.

ALTERNATIVE 7-MARK QUESTIONS (Exam Practice)

- (e ii) For a named country with a youthful population, explain the potential benefits of its population structure for future economic development. [7]
- (e iii) Compare the population structures of a named country with a youthful population and a named country with an ageing population, and explain the different problems each faces. [7]

11. Summary Card — Cut Out and Revise

	Nigeria — YOUTHFUL	Japan — AGEING
DTM Stage	Stage 3 (late expanding)	Stage 4–5 (declining)
TFR	5.1	1.2 (record low)
Median age	18 years	49 years
Under 15	43%	12%
Over 65	3%	29%
Dep. ratio	~85 (YOUTH)	~70 (ELDERLY)
Life expectancy	~54 years	~84 years
Pyramid shape	Expansive — very wide base	Constrictive — narrow base, wide top
Key problems	• Overwhelmed schools • Youth unemployment (40%) • Healthcare shortage (1 dr/5,000) • Housing — 60%+ Lagos in slums	• Pension crisis (~10% GDP) • Shrinking workforce (-600k/yr) • Healthcare costs doubling • Rural depopulation
Key opportunity	Demographic dividend — if young cohort educated and employed	Robot automation; limited immigration reform
Management	Investment in education; family planning; job creation programmes	Angel Plans (FAILING — TFR 1.2); robots; raised retirement age; immigration

EXAM ALERT

Cambridge 0460 Paper 1 Section B: 1 + 2 + 3 + 4 + 7 mark structure.
Always name your case study in EVERY sentence: "In Nigeria..." / "Japan's ageing population..." — never "a country."
7-mark answer: description + explanation + named data + evaluation of management + conclusion.
Key comparisons to revise: Nigeria (youthful, Stage 3, TFR 5.1) vs Japan (ageing, Stage 4–5, TFR 1.2).
Dependency ratio formula must be memorised: (pop 0–14 + pop 65+) ÷ pop 15–64 × 100.